

Mirko Wegemann

Institute for Political Science · University of Münster
Scharnhorstraße 100, 48151 Münster
m.wegemann@uni-muenster.de · <https://mirko-wegemann.github.io/>

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Comparative politics · Political parties · Far-right extremism · Gender and political representation · Social norms · Computational text analysis · Experimental research

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

since 10/2024 **Postdoctoral Researcher**
University of Münster, Institute for Political Science
Chair of Comparative Politics, Prof. Dr. Daniel Bischof

EDUCATION

09/20 – 09/24 **PhD Candidate at European University Institute (Florence, Italy)**
Thesis: “Roads to the Establishment? How Challengers Become Mainstream.”
Supervisor: Ellen M. Immergut (European University Institute)

04/18 – 08/20 **Master of Arts (Social Sciences) at Humboldt-University (Berlin, Germany)**
Supervisors: Thomas Meyer and Heiko Giebler
Thesis Grade: 1.1

10/14 – 09/18 **Bachelor of Arts (Social Sciences) at Humboldt-University (Berlin, Germany)**
Supervisors: Konstantin Vössing and Diana Burlacu
Thesis Grade: 1.1

RESEARCH VISITS

10/23 – 02/24 **Visiting PhD at DYNAMICS Research Training Group (Berlin, Germany)**
Sponsor: Heike Klüver

08/22 – 02/23 **Visiting PhD at University of Vienna (Vienna, Austria)**
Sponsor: Thomas M. Meyer

09/19 – 02/20 **Erasmus Exchange at LUISS Guido Carli (Rome, Italy)**

ACADEMIC WORK EXPERIENCE

09/23 – 09/24	Academic assistant <i>Project: Political explanations and their effects on public opinion and political behavior funded by the Hans-Böckler-Stiftung</i>
11/23 – 05/24	Academic assistant <i>Project: Experimental survey on public acceptance of climate protest funded by the Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung</i>
03/23 – 07/23	Student research assistant <i>Institution: European University Institute, Florence</i>
01/22 – 05/22	Student research assistant <i>Project: Responding to COVID-19: Government Action, Government Rhetoric, and Public Trust</i> <i>Institution: European University Institute, Florence</i>
07/21 – 09/21	Student research assistant <i>Project: Voting advice application (euandi)</i> <i>Institution: European University Institute, Florence</i>
08/16 – 12/20	Student research assistant <i>Project: HEALTHDOX, NORFACE</i> <i>Institution: Humboldt University, Berlin</i>
02/16 – 09/16	Student research assistant <i>Project: Experiences of discrimination in Germany</i> <i>Institution: Humboldt University, Berlin</i>
10/15 – 09/18	Student research assistant and tutor <i>Institution: Humboldt-University of Berlin</i>

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

10/25 – 03/26	Political Parties in a Comparative Perspective (undergraduates) <i>Institute for Political Science, University of Münster</i> Lecturer Materials: here
10/25 – 03/26	Challenges to Democracy (undergraduates) <i>Institute for Political Science, University of Münster</i> Lecturer Materials: here
04/25 – 09/25	Party Competition in Western Europe (graduates) <i>Institute for Political Science, University of Münster</i> Lecturer Materials: here
04/25 – 09/25	Gender and Political Representation (undergraduates) <i>Institute for Political Science, University of Münster</i> Lecturer Materials: here

10/24 – 03/25	Workshop on Computational Text Analysis (postgraduates) <i>Department of Social and Political Sciences, European University Institute, Florence</i> Lecturer Materials: here
10/24 – 03/25	Challenges to Democracy (graduates) <i>Institute for Political Science, University of Münster</i> Lecturer Materials: here
10/24 – 03/25	Quantitative Textanalyse (German) (undergraduates) <i>Institute for Political Science, University of Münster</i> Lecturer Materials: here
10/22 – 02/23	Comparative Politics (undergraduates) <i>Department of Governance, University of Vienna</i> Lecturer
04/2022	Computational Text Analysis (PhD candidates) <i>Department of Political and Social Science at the European University Institute (Florence)</i> Teaching Assistant for Prof. Dr. Theresa Gessler
10/21 – 12/21	Intermediate Quantitative Methods (PhD candidates) <i>Department of Political and Social Science at the European University Institute (Florence)</i> Teaching Assistant for Prof. Dr. Arnout van de Rijt and Prof. Dr. Juho Härkönen
10/15 – 09/18	Introduction to Statistics I & II (undergraduates) <i>Department of Empirical Social Research at Humboldt-University (Berlin)</i> Teaching Assistant for Prof. Dr. Johannes Giesecke

WORKING PAPERS

- “Why does representation matter? The role of descriptive representation in policy justifications.” Currently under review (Draft available upon request)
- “When Ambiguity Backfires: The Interplay between Programmatic and Parliamentary Ambiguity” (Draft available upon request)
- “Going local? How mainstream parties react to the local framing of migration by the radical right.” (Draft available upon request)
- “Activists’ trade-offs: social movement strategies and their effects on public support” – with Konstantin Vössing and Phillip Genschel
- “Citizens’ Narrow Views of Democracy: Insights from Open-Ended Survey Responses” – with Elena Leuschner, Tim Lars Allinger, Daniel Bischof, Kristian Frederiksen and Morgan Le Corre Juratic
- “Are we all in the same boat? The role of multi-level party competition on intra-party cohesion” – with Rebecca Kittel
- “Still a century of partisan politics? Partisanship, veto points, and European healthcare legislation, 1990-2019” – with Ellen M. Immergut, Alexandru D. Moise and Tamara Popic
- “Reminiscing the good old days. How far-right parties deter the female losers of technological change.” – with Leon D. Küstermann

- “Girls, do your homework! The long-term legacy of gender-typed curricula in post-War Germany.” (Draft available upon request)
- “Politics of Language. The Consequences of Banning Gender-Inclusive Language“ – with Anica Waldendorf
- “Leave for Office. How Parental Leave Frameworks Affect Women’s Representation in Local Politics“ (Draft available upon request)
- “How Good Ancestors Make Good Citizens: Norm Legacies and the Activation of Pro-Social Behavior” – with Violeta Haas

GRANTS & SCHOLARSHIPS

- **2026: British Academy Small Research Grant** (Co-PI with Anica Waldendorf)
Organization: British Academy
Type: Funding for Survey Experiment (9,774 GBP)
- **2026: Leuchtturm Projekt *CitiParti*** (Co-PI with Elena Leuschner)
Organization: Universitätsgesellschaft Münster
Type: Funding for Field Experiment (14975)
- **2026: John Fell Fund** (Co-PI with Anica Waldendorf)
Organization: Oxford University
Type: Funding for Survey Experiment (9,774 GBP)
- **Fully funded PhD Scholarship at the European University Institute in Florence**
Organization: German Academic Scholarship Foundation
Type: Full tuition costs and stipend
- **Erasmus+ Mobility Grant**
Sending Institution: Humboldt University, Berlin
Hosting Institution: LUISS Guido Carli, Rome
Type: Erasmus student exchange
- **Erasmus+ Staff Training Mobility Grant**
Sending Institution: Humboldt University, Berlin
Hosting Institution: Central European University, Budapest
Type: ECPR Summer School on Methods
- **SPS Travel Grant**
Sending Institution: Humboldt University of Berlin
Hosting Institution: European University Institute, Florence
Type: SPS Summer School on Solidarity & Inequality

AWARDS

- **Honorary Mention (Ernst B. Haas Best Dissertation Award)**
Organization: American Political Science Association (European Politics Section)

WORKSHOPS & SUMMER SCHOOLS

02/24	Workshop “Current Perspectives on Party Competition” <i>Mannheim Centre for European Social Research (MZES)</i>
11/22	Workshop on Political Justifications <i>European University Institute (Florence, Italy)</i>

- 08/22 **ECPR Summer School on the Far-Right**
Sciences Po (Paris, France)
 Courses and student presentations on different actors of the far-right
- 08/21 **ECPR Summer School on Political Parties**
Aarhus University (Aarhus, Denmark)
 Courses and student presentation on different dimensions of party organization, strategy and competition
- 07/19 **ECPR Summer School on Methods**
Central European University (Budapest)
 Course on automated collection of web and social media data
- 06/19 **SPS Summer School on Solidarity and Inequality in Europe**
European University Institute (Florence)
 Courses and student presentations on welfare state futures and European solidarity

INVITED TALKS

- 03/2026 Workshop on „Overloaded Bureaucracies“ at the Center for Advanced Studies, Munich, Germany.
- 11/2025 Workshop on „Elections, Public Opinion & Elite Behaviour“ at the Herie School of Governance, Berlin, Germany.
- 07/2025 Invited talk on the „Politics of Language“ in the Social Data Laboratory, Bremen, Germany.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2026 PEDD (University of Münster), COMPTXT (Birmingham)
- 2025 APSA (Vancouver), EPSA (Madrid —*cancelled due to illness*)
- 2024 APSA (Philadelphia —*cancelled due to defence of dissertation*), EPSA (Cologne), Gradnet (Zurich)
- 2023 SISP (Genoa), EPSA (Glasgow), COMPTXT (Glasgow)
- 2022 ECPR General Conference (Innsbruck), EPSA (Prague)

SERVICES TO THE PROFESSION

- since 2024 Co-organization of speaker series on “Understanding Democracies: Challenges and Solutions”, University of Münster
- 09/2021 Presentation on the German Election Campaigns 2021 at the European University Institute, Florence
- 2021 Student Representative at European University Institute
- Reviewer for *Party Politics*

QUALIFICATIONS

Statistical software	Stata, SPSS, R, Python
Database management	SQL, Excel
Survey design	Qualtrics, Limesurvey
Text processing	Word, LaTeX
Teaching	Certificate in ‘Introduction to Teaching and Learning in Higher Education’ at the European University Institute

METHODS TRAINING

Regression analyses	Introduction to statistics for social scientists and advanced methods of regression analyses (like panel data analyses, survival analyses and count models) at different stages of professional development
Causal inference	‘The Statistics of Causal Inference’ taught by Prof. Andrea Ichino, Prof. Miriam Golden and Prof. Elias Dinas at the European University Institute The course included various methods of causal inference (DiD, RDD, IV, etc.) and involved the understanding of underlying assumption and the application of these methods following data simulation.
Computational text analysis	Several courses and workshops on different methods of computational text analysis (e.g., ‘Computational Text Analysis’ taught by Prof. Dr. Theresa Gessler at ECPR Summer School and European University Institute, and workshops on deep learning and transformer models at the COMPTTEXT conference by Moritz Lauer and Dr. Chris Arnold)
Survey experiments	Workshop on survey experiments taught by Prof. Robert Johns at the European University Institute

LANGUAGES

Germany (native) · English (fluent / C2) · French (B1/B2) · Italian (B1) ·